

Ideation Phase

Automated Network Request Management

Date	06/09/2026
Team ID	Servicenow
Project Name	Automated Network Request Management
Maximum Marks	10 Marks

1. Empathize & Discover — Empathy Map Canvas (4 Marks)

An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviours and attitudes.

It is a useful tool to help teams better understand their users.

Creating an effective solution requires understanding the true problem and the person who is experiencing it. The exercise of creating the map helps participants consider things from the user's perspective along with his or her goals and challenges.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/empathy-map-canvas>

Application: Automated Network Request Management

Persona: An employee who needs to raise a request for a new or existing network connection through the organization's IT department.

Hear - IT says manual approvals take days - Manager: network changes need sign-off - Colleagues complain about follow-up calls	Network Requester (Persona)	See - Generic tools, no network-request option - Email threads with unclear approval status - IT tracking requests on spreadsheets
Think & Feel - This process should be as simple as raising any other IT request - Worried the request will get lost in email threads or forgotten - Wants clear confirmation that the request is moving forward		
Say & Do - Sends multiple follow-up emails to check on request status - Calls the IT helpdesk directly for updates - Re-enters the same request details across different channels		

Pain

- No visibility into where the request stands in the approval process
- Manual, error-prone handling of request details
- Delays in fulfilment due to the lack of a structured workflow

Gain

- A single, guided form to submit the request
- Real-time visibility into approval and fulfilment status
- Faster turnaround through automated routing and notifications

2. Define the Problem Statements (2 Marks)

Create a problem statement to understand your customer's point of view. The Customer Problem Statement template helps you focus on what matters to create experiences people will love.

A well-articulated customer problem statement allows you and your team to find the ideal solution for the challenges your customers face. Throughout the process, you'll also be able to empathize with your customers, which helps you better understand how they perceive your product or service.

Reference: <https://miro.com/templates/customer-problem-statement/>

Automated Network Request Management — Problem Statements:

Problem Statement (PS)	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	an employee who needs a new or existing network connection	submit a network service request quickly and track its progress	there is no structured system — requests go through emails and phone calls	network requests are not centralized on a single platform with defined approval stages	frustrated and uncertain about when the request will be fulfilled
PS-2	a member of the IT / network fulfilment team	process and approve network requests efficiently	I have to manually track approvals and request data across emails and spreadsheets	there is no automated workflow linking request intake to approval routing	overwhelmed, and at risk of errors during manual handling

3. Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization (4 Marks)

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Problem statement selected for the brainstorm (from PS-1 and PS-2 above):

“How might we enable employees to raise and track network service requests through a single, automated system — while giving IT teams a structured, policy-compliant way to review and fulfil them?”

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Ideas generated to address the problem statement:

#	Idea	Group
1	Build a fully custom Service Portal widget with client scripts for the request form	Custom Development
2	Use a standard Service Catalog item with catalog variables and a variable set	Native ServiceNow Configuration
3	Automate approval and record creation using custom Business Rules and Script Includes	Custom Development
4	Automate approval and record creation using a no-code Flow Designer flow	Native ServiceNow Configuration
5	Integrate with third-party network tools for auto-provisioning (e.g. Cisco DNA Center)	Integration
6	Route approvals manually over email	Manual Process
7	Route approvals using ServiceNow's native Approval engine (sysapprovals)	Native ServiceNow Configuration
8	Store requests in an existing ITSM table instead of a new custom table	Native ServiceNow Configuration
9	Create a new custom table (Database Tables) dedicated to network requests	Native ServiceNow Configuration

Step-3: Idea Prioritization (Importance vs. Feasibility)

Each idea was plotted against importance to the problem statement and feasibility within the project's scope and timeline:

Idea	Importance	Feasibility	Decision
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Service Catalog item + variables + variable set	High	High	Selected
Flow Designer for automation and approval routing	High	High	Selected
Native Approval engine (sysapprovals)	High	High	Selected
New custom table (Database Tables) for requests	High	High	Selected
Custom Business Rules / Script Includes	High	Low	Rejected — adds complexity without added benefit over Flow Designer
Custom Service Portal widget	Medium	Low	Rejected — standard catalog experience already meets the need
Third-party integration (auto-provisioning)	High	Low	Deferred — noted as a future enhancement
Manual email-based approval	Low	High	Rejected — does not solve the core problem
Reuse existing ITSM table	Low	Medium	Rejected — a dedicated table gives cleaner data and reporting

Final Selected Approach:

Automate network request intake and approval end-to-end using a Service Catalog item (with variables and a variable set), a dedicated custom table (Database Tables / u_database_tables), and a Flow Designer flow that creates the record, sends notifications, and routes the request through ServiceNow's native approval engine. This combination scored highest on both importance and feasibility, requires no custom scripting, and is straightforward to maintain and extend.